Basic Fractions

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Basic fractions

What is a fraction?

- A fraction is written as $\frac{a}{b}$ where *a* and *b* are **integers**
  - The number on the top, *a*, is called the **numerator**
  - The number on the bottom, *b*, is called the **denominator**
- The **values** of the numerator and denominator tell us about the **size** of the fraction
  - The denominator is how many **parts** each whole number is split into
  - The numerator is how many **parts** you **have**
    - For example, $\frac{2}{3}$ means that each whole number is divided into 3 parts and you have 2 of these parts
- A fraction is **less** than 1 if the numerator is **smaller** than the denominator
- A fraction is **more** than 1 if the number is **bigger** than the denominator

How do I find a fraction of an amount?

- **Method 1**
  Divide by the **denominator** and **multiply** by the **numerator**
  - To find $\frac{2}{5}$ of 60, divide it by 5 then multiply it by 2
    - $60 \div 5 = 12$, then $12 \times 2 = 24$
- **Method 2**
  Change the fraction into a **decimal**, then **multiply**
  - To find $\frac{9}{10}$ of 15, turn $\frac{9}{10}$ into 0.9 then multiply
    - $0.9 \times 15 = 13.5$
- **Method 3**
  Write both numbers as fractions and **multiply the two fractions** together
  - To find $\frac{5}{6}$ of 8, turn 8 into $\frac{8}{1}$
    - Work out $\frac{5}{6} \times \frac{8}{1} = \frac{40}{6} = \frac{20}{3}$

Help me understand

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

same amount
  - They are different ways of writing the same thing
  - For example, $\frac{1}{2}$ and $\frac{6}{12}$ are equivalent fractions

How do I find an equivalent fraction?

- To find an equivalent fraction, **multiply the top and bottom** of a fraction by the same number
  - $\frac{5}{6}$ is equivalent to $\frac{5 \times 2}{6 \times 2} = \frac{10}{12}$ and $\frac{5 \times 3}{6 \times 3} = \frac{15}{18}$ and $\frac{5 \times 4}{6 \times 4} = \frac{20}{24}$ etc.
  - For each fraction, there are an **infinite number** of equivalent fractions

What is a simplified fraction?

- A **simplified fraction** is a fraction that is written using the **smallest** possible **integer values**
  - Simplifying turns a fraction into an 'easier' **equivalent fraction**

- If both the numerator and denominator can be divided by the **same number** (called a **common factor**), the fraction can be **simplified**
- Simplifying is also called **cancelling** a fraction

How do I simplify fractions?

- To simplify the fraction, **divide the top and bottom** by the common factor

- $\frac{12}{18} = \frac{12 \div 6}{18 \div 6} = \frac{2}{3}$
- $\frac{25}{45} = \frac{25 \div 5}{45 \div 5} = \frac{5}{9}$

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Make use of your calculator in your exam:

- Typing any fraction into it and pressing equals will automatically simplify the fraction for you.
- If the question asks you to show your working, you must show which number you divided by.

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